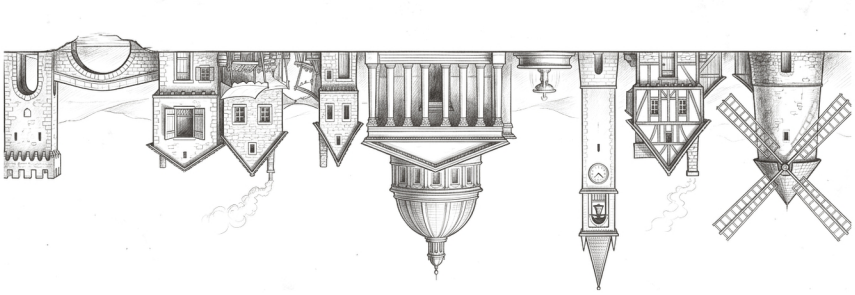
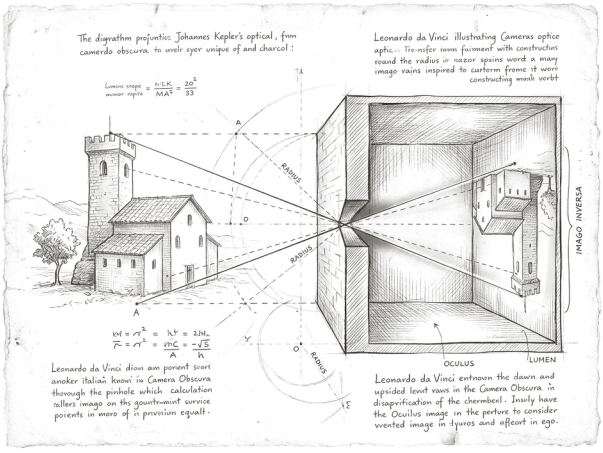
The Camera Obscura

Beyond the gate of masks, I enter a dark chamber pierced by a single aperture. Through this pinhole, sunlight projects the living city of Tower III onto the stone wall, cast upside down by the geometry of light. Here in this codex, I have drawn the streets as they stood the day before the raiders struck.

Keep this page beside you. In the chamber ahead, four things in the city have changed since this sketch was made. Find each difference—and watch where smoke rises, for the raiders leave their trace in fire.





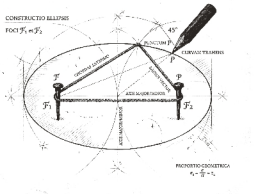
The Three Hearths

In this codex, two hearths send white smoke into the sky: the mill and the market lodge. If the chamber ahead reveals a third chimney breathing fire, seek the narrow door beneath it. The raiders kindle hearths where none should burn.

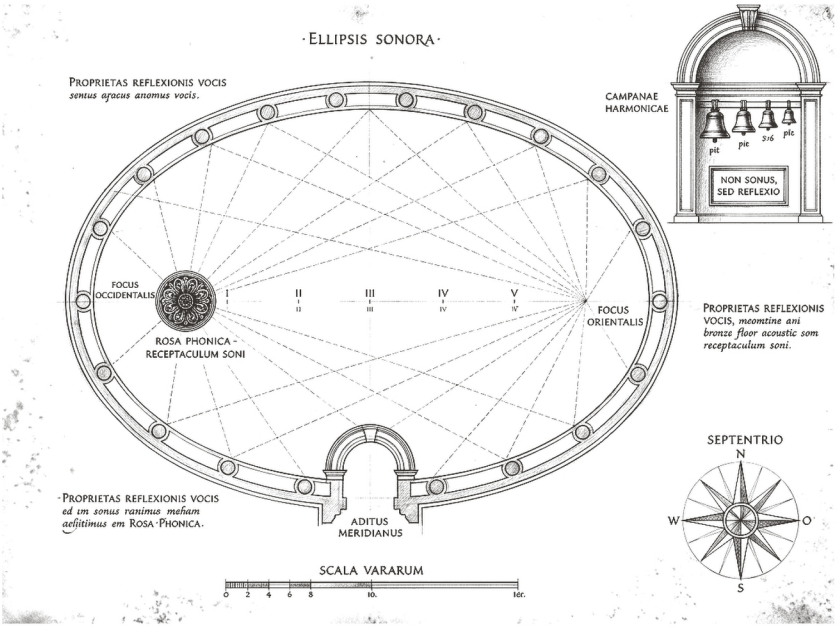
The seal of this room. Scan it with your camera when the door asks for it.

The Whispering Gallery

Beneath the narrow house, past the hearth where the raiders lit their fire, a stair leads to a silent hall with no corners. The Order laid it out using Kepler's planetary orbits: two pins in the stone, a string of ten varas, and a taut pencil. A whisper at one pin travels the curved wall to the other, clear as a bell. Nowhere else.



The pins are gone, but the string never stretched. Find where they stood along the floor: five varas measured from the northern curve to the central axis marks the listening rose. The raiders whisper at the eastern pin: stand at the western one, and listen.



The Secret of the Niche

The stone vault does not repeat a song: it mirrors it. When the five bronze bells of the niche ring across the stones, answer them not as they sounded, but from the last chime to the first.

« Non sonus, sed reflexio. »